

Day 4 — Kapha — The Structure Principle

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify kapha-style behaviours (steady, cool, moist, structured).

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *kapha* (IAST: kapha; lit. “structure principle (cohesion, ap+pr̥thvī)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Observe structure.** Hold up a rock or thick block. “*This stays in shape. It is solid, cool, heavy. It holds its form.*” Kapha = the structure principle.
2. **Define *kapha*.** Five subtypes:
 - *avalambaka* — lubrication of joints, chest
 - *kledaka* — stomach moisture
 - *bodhaka* — saliva, taste
 - *tarpaka* — brain cushioning
 - *śleṣaka* — joint cohesion
3. **Kapha qualities (*guṇas*):** heavy, slow, cool, oily, smooth, soft, dense, stable, gross. Compare with vāta + pitta.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 12 on *kapha-prakopa*: heaviness, sluggishness, congestion, weight gain, emotional attachment.
5. **Modern bridge.** *Kapha* maps loosely to *anabolic / structural metabolism, connective-tissue density, parasympathetic dominance*. Wellness lens, not diagnosis. “*Why might a ‘kapha person’ thrive in a stable, predictable routine?*”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Kapha — The Structure Principle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).